

INDIEFFERENTIAL

# WHAT'S NEW?

by indiefferential

LAUREN MOON | JULY VOL .5 2026

Photography by Melody Battentier

*Lauren Moon*

# WELCOME TO INDIEFFERENTIAL

Do you remember that time you discovered your favorite band? What was that like? How did it feel? Over the years we have found different ways of discovering new music and other formats of entertainment. Some of you already remember the first time you bought a vinyl record or a CD.

For me, it was one of the best experiences when I bought an AC/DC CD freshly bought ready to be played at full volume in my parent's Hi-Fi system. The physical aspect of the release always was something that stayed with me for a long time and I loved the whole experience of having that CD, inserting it into the system, controlling the volume and listening to my favorite tracks over and over again. Everything that came along with the CD was a bonus, you could look at pictures, read about the band and have something to do while experiencing their music.

Right now most music is released in digital formats and you can't really experience this. Magazines were also something that introduced me to my favorite bands back in the day. I remember reading about the Killers long before listening to their hits on the radio. Still, the physical aspect of the discovery was significant, for me at least. Of course, it's a lot easier to find out great music these days and not buy seven different CDs to discover what you like.

Enough with the past though, let's move to today, you can stream music, films and series and many people don't bother buying magazines or CDs. I am one of these people who loves to collect things and I also own many video games in digital and physical format. Even though some of my favorite video games are in a library on my computer, I always cherish the time I take to look through the case of an older video game, its pamphlets and artwork.

This is one of the reasons we started Indiefferential. The experience of holding a physical magazine in your hands, reading about these new bands from the other side of the world while you listen to their music online sending them a DM that you love their work. This is what Indiefferential is all about, keeping the good aspects of physical releases and combining this experience with the modern opportunities technology provides.

Indiefferential is here for every artist out there, we love what we do and we will keep posting about your music and projects so people can find out their new favorite artist. Our plan is to post consistently about new artists and creators, in that way, your audience will find out about another great band and their audience will discover your work. This is how Indiefferential works, always supporting artists in order to find the right audience and have their work sent across the whole world.

Got your printed copy of  
Indiefferential?

Tag @indiefferential and be featured  
in our highlights permanently!



*George Skandros*

NOW PLAYING...



Follow us on Spotify so  
you can find your next  
favorite artist!



Follow us on Instagram  
for music news and  
exclusive features!

If you are interested in a feature on  
Indiefferential, feel free to tell us  
more about your music, product or  
project.

Features and interviews  
[editorial@indiefferential.com](mailto:editorial@indiefferential.com)

**Head Editor** George S.  
**Social Media** Emily W.  
**Managing Editor** Mark H.



Atticus Roness brings timeless rock energy into the modern spotlight

Atticus Roness approaches rock and roll with the conviction of an artist who understands its enduring power. Built around infectious melodies, larger than life performances, and an unmistakable stage presence, his music carries the spirit of classic rock while maintaining the urgency of a contemporary independent artist finding his audience.

His latest single, 'Wives' Tale, feels deliberately timeless, shaped with the kind of melodic confidence and direct songwriting that could belong to any era. The track carries a sense of nostalgia without becoming trapped in the past, balancing familiar rock instincts with the raw ambition of an artist determined to make his mark.

That ambition is already translating into momentum, with Roness attracting thousands of new monthly listeners as anticipation builds around his forthcoming album, 'Rock 'N' Roll Hit Parade'. There is a clear sense of movement behind the project, driven by songs designed to connect quickly while rewarding repeat listens.

With his ear for memorable hooks and his instinct for performance, Roness embodies the theatrical confidence and rebellious spirit that have always defined great rock and roll. 'Wives' Tale offers another glimpse of an artist ready to turn obscurity into something much louder.



EPIC NELSON bring classic rock fire into a modern live setting

EPIC NELSON have built their identity around the enduring power of rock and roll, channeling classic rock, blues, vintage influences, melodic songwriting, and modern energy into a sound designed to connect with audiences. Led by founder and vocalist Eric Nelson III, the Bay Area band brings a sense of scale and excitement to every performance, balancing soaring vocals with fiery guitar work and an instinct for memorable hooks.

Their music carries the grit and warmth of blues rock while embracing the immediacy of contemporary rock, creating songs that feel both familiar and alive. Yet it is onstage where the band's personality truly comes into focus. EPIC NELSON approach performance as a shared experience, encouraging audiences to sing, move, and lose themselves in the moment.

There is a genuine joy behind the band's sound, an appreciation for the communal spirit that has always made rock music so powerful. Rather than chasing complexity for its own sake, EPIC NELSON focus on energy, musicianship, and emotional connection, delivering performances that leave a lasting impression.

With their combination of classic influences, dynamic songwriting, and unrestrained live presence, EPIC NELSON embody the celebratory side of rock and roll, proving that the genre still thrives when played with conviction and heart.



Voice Of Glass turn spiritual searching into expansive modern rock

For more than two decades, Voice Of Glass have shaped a distinctive musical language built from emotion, spirituality, and a refusal to settle inside conventional genre boundaries. Founded in 2002 by guitarist David Meek and vocalist Olya Meek, the American band has evolved from its early beginnings in Bulgaria into a project that draws equally from gothic music, metal, alternative rock, progressive textures, and hard rock.

Their songs are driven by expressive melodies and intricate arrangements, creating space for themes that reach beyond the personal into questions of faith, identity, and the deeper nature of existence. Rather than treating music as simple entertainment, Voice Of Glass approach it as an extension of the soul, using sound to translate experiences that words alone cannot always express.

Across an extensive catalogue of releases, the band have developed a layered sonic identity that balances power with atmosphere. Their production carries weight without sacrificing emotional detail, allowing each element to contribute to a larger, immersive experience.

A 2024 signing with Revlux Records opened a new chapter for the group, bringing renewed momentum to an artistic journey defined by independence and conviction. Voice Of Glass continue to create music that seeks not only to be heard, but to reach listeners somewhere deeper.



# Now, Forever, The haunting soundscapes of i give my friends flowers



The music industry is built on stories, and few are as compellingly layered as that of Jacob Klein, the artist behind the moniker i give my friends flowers. Emerging from a decade spent honing his craft as a producer and engineer across Nashville, Pittsburgh, New York, and Asheville, he's crafted an intensely personal body of work rooted in experience, specifically, experiences marked by loss, resilience, and a deep-seated desire to find meaning amidst chaos. The resulting albums, *A River Runs Through Me* and *DOGSTAR 1*, aren't just collections of songs; they are intimate chronicles of transformation.

The artist's sound is immediately recognizable for its melancholic beauty and quiet intensity. It's a blend of atmospheric electronic textures, thoughtful lyricism, and a raw emotional honesty that resonates deeply. Influences abound, from the cinematic landscapes of David Lynch to the sonic explorations of Pink Floyd, but it remains distinctly his own. The production quality across *DOGSTAR 1* is remarkably detailed; each layer feels carefully considered, contributing to an immersive soundscape that pulls the listener into Klein's world.

The genesis of this music can be traced back to a particularly turbulent period in Klein's life. Following years spent caring for his grandfather during the pandemic

and witnessing firsthand the devastating impact of the drug epidemic in Pennsylvania, he sought refuge in Asheville, only to face further heartbreak with the terminal illness of his beloved dog. These events forged a profound sense of vulnerability within him, a vulnerability that ultimately became the core of his artistic expression. The 2024 hurricane, Hurricane Helene, served as another devastating catalyst, displacing communities and forcing Klein to confront layers of internal pain he hadn't fully acknowledged before.

This difficult period culminated in a shared exhale with his brother and close friends, resulting in the initial EP, *Now, Forever*. However, as Klein began to find his footing again, circumstances shifted dramatically, his brother

er moved away, prompting him to pursue a more solitary creative path. This led to the construction of a new home studio in West Asheville and ultimately fueled the creation of his latest releases.

The recently released EP, *In Case of Emergencies Draw a Door*, exemplifies this shift. Yet, even amidst the chaos unleashed by Hurricane Helene, which scattered friends and collaborators and forced a temporary halt to releasing music, Klein found himself drawn back to writing. The resulting work, culminating in *A River Runs Through Me*, explores the profound experience of allowing grief, memory, and change to flow through one's being; it centers around the belief that we don't control what affects us, but rather how we respond.

The production process itself is a testament to Klein's dedication. He tracked and produced *In Case of Emergencies Draw a Door* across various locations, Pittsburgh, Asheville, and the New River Gorge, collaborating with longtime friend Harrison Wargo (of *BADBOXES*) and incorporating familiar spaces like his parents' house outside Pittsburgh, where he first fell in love with music. The artist's creative touchstones, figures like Haruki Murakami, David Lynch, Alejandro Jodorowsky, David Hockney, serve as

constant reminders of the power of art to connect us, offer courage, and propel us forward.

The single *pollen* showcases this beautifully; beginning simply with piano and vocals before blossoming into a warmer, more expansive electronic soundscape reminiscent of Sampha's *Lahai*, it powerfully addresses the universal struggle between distraction and the arduous process of healing. The song's lyrics delve into the temptation of quick fixes, partying, new towns, and ultimately encourage listeners to confront their vulnerabilities head-on. With *A River Runs Through Me*, *DOGSTAR 1* and *DOGSTAR 2* on the horizon, Jacob Klein is charting a course through an uncertain future, one defined by love, dedication, and the unwavering pursuit of creation.





# The Expansive Palette of Lauren Moon

Lauren Moon is a sonic architect, meticulously crafting landscapes of emotion within her music. Based in London and operating largely outside the established industry structures, currently unsigned, she's steadily building a dedicated following through a commitment to authentic songwriting and a truly captivating vocal delivery. The artist creates music that feels both intimately personal and universally resonant, a quality frequently highlighted by critics who describe her work as widescreen cinematic and brimming with emotional intensity.

Her sound is a compelling blend of alt-pop sensibilities with the core tenets of classic songwriting and a distinctly indie aesthetic. It's a tapestry woven from influences that span decades, incorporating the timelessness of artists like Joni Mitchell alongside the energy of contemporary pop. This expansive palette is expertly realized through her multi-instrumentalism; Lauren plays piano, guitar, harmonica, and ukulele, each instrument contributing to the rich textures of her compositions. The result is music that feels immediate, as if plucked directly from a lived experience, yet possesses an enduring quality.

The artist's voice itself is central to this effect. It's de-

scribed as identifiable, emotive, sincere, and entirely devoid of artifice. This vocal intimacy draws the listener into the heart of each song's narrative, amplifying the emotional weight of every lyric. The production quality consistently supports this vulnerability; it's never overly polished or slick, retaining a raw honesty that feels crucial to the overall impact. Her recent single, *Running Low*, exemplifies this perfectly.

The track swells with a cinematic feel, further enhanced by Lauren's intense and beautifully melodic vocals. It establishes a sensual atmosphere while maintaining strong melodic writing and emotional depth, as *Louder Than War* noted, it's full of emotional intensity, glorified further by Lauren's intense and beautifully melodic vocals which draw you into the very heart of the song's narrative. The production expertly balances these elements, creating an immersive listening experience. Furthermore, a striking music video for *Running Low*, directed by Jack and Mars, extends the song's cinematic world into the visual realm, adding another layer to the already rich artistic statement.

Lauren Moon's musical journey is intrinsically linked to

her upbringing. Born into a family of professional musicians, she was immersed in music from an early age, developing a natural instinct for melody and storytelling. This foundation informs every aspect of her work, from the carefully constructed arrangements to the deeply personal lyrics. Adding another layer of fascinating context is her collaboration with bassist Peter Perrett Jr., who brings significant experience to the project, having previously performed with artists such as Bryan Ferry and Babyshambles. Notably, he also contributed to the critically acclaimed return of Peter Perrett (Sr.), frontman of *The Only Ones*, a band known for their iconic new wave track *Another Girl, Another Planet*.

Ultimately, Lauren Moon represents a rare breed of artist, one deeply committed to her craft and unafraid to express herself with honesty and vulnerability. Her music isn't simply about creating catchy tunes; it's about forging genuine connections with listeners through the power of song. She is quietly establishing herself as an artist who prioritizes emotional resonance above all else, leaving behind echoes of a lost coast, a place where melancholic beauty and timeless storytelling converge.









## Two Friends & Their Wild Music

Stagger, released on July 3rd, 2026, is a thrilling exploration of betrayal wrapped in the kind of raw, unpolished production that defined rock music in the late 90s and early 2000s. The single represents a bold statement from Wolves of Delphi, a Reading-based rock duo determined to reignite a passion for authentic musical experience. It's an immediate immersion into a world where sonic textures matter more than slick perfection, a deliberate rejection of the prevailing trends in contemporary music production.

The core of Wolves of Delphi's sound lies within the dynamic partnership between Black Wolf and White Wolf, two friends who have cultivated a powerful creative connection despite geographical distance. Their musical origin story is rooted in a shared desire to maintain this bond, translating into a potent synergy that fuels their songwriting and performance. This collaboration channels the raw, visceral energy of rock's golden era, a deliberate homage to bands that prioritized emotional impact over technical virtuosity. The duo's music is clearly influenced by

legendary acts like Audioslave, although they forge their own distinct path by grounding their sound in timeless themes of myth and legend.

Stagger itself is a masterclass in deliberately eschewing the clinical perfection often associated with modern releases. The production quality is remarkably organic, boasting an energy that serves as a potent antidote to what many perceive as overproduction within contemporary rock music. It's music designed to excite, a throwback to an era when a single song could ignite genuine passion in listeners. The track avoids any attempt at polished refinement, opting instead for a soundscape that feels immediate and unfiltered, capturing the essence of a live performance with an intensity rarely found today.

The duo's ambition is clear: they are Wolves of Delphi. They will be heard. This isn't merely about creating music; it's about advocating for a return to the core values of rock, honest songwriting, emotional vulnerability, and a refusal to compromise artistic integrity. The artists under-

stand that in an industry saturated with manufactured sounds and fleeting trends, staying true to one's vision is paramount. Stagger stands defiantly apart from the mundane, offering a visceral reminder of why rock music matters.

The track's thematic focus on betrayal, woven into a narrative steeped in myth and legend, adds another layer of depth to the experience. The powerful delivery suggests an intentional effort to capture listeners' attention with stories delivered with passionate intensity; something that has been sorely missing from much modern rock. With Stagger, Wolves of Delphi have proven they're not just making music, but building a statement.





# A Forgotten Ballroom: VelumVelvet Presents

permeates every aspect of VelumVelvet's sound, from the synth-laden textures to the carefully constructed arrangements. However, the artist deliberately resists categorization, drawing inspiration from an astonishingly diverse range of sources. The echoes of David Bowie's theatricality intertwine with the soulful intensity of Annie Lennox, while the introspective vulnerability of Billie Eilish and the stark honesty of Daughter find resonance

within her compositions. Even the melodic sensibilities of Ed Sheeran contribute to the complex tapestry that defines VelumVelvet's unique voice.

The artist's process is particularly intriguing. She describes crafting songs from word soups, collections of fragmented thoughts, memories, and observations that slowly coalesce into emotionally resonant narratives. This method allows for a deeply personal connection with each piece, resulting in music characterized by raw vulnerability and quiet intensity. James records her vocals at home, prioritizing genuine emotion over pristine production. This deliberate choice elevates the tracks beyond simple pop songs; they become intimate confessions, delivered with

an undeniable sense of sincerity. The result is a sound that is both hauntingly beautiful and profoundly relatable.

Her recent release continues this trend, a further expansion of the conceptual House of Emotional Rooms. Each track offers a distinct sonic landscape designed to evoke specific feelings, encouraging listeners to project their own experiences onto the music. It's an invitation to introspection, a space where personal narratives can intertwine with the artist's carefully constructed visions. The intention isn't simply to entertain; it's to create a shared emotional experience, one that acknowledges the complexities of human connection and the enduring power of memory.

VelumVelvet is more than just an artistic endeavor; it's a statement about authenticity and the transformative potential of creative expression. James has built something truly special, a collection of sonic rooms where listeners can find solace, reflection, or perhaps simply a moment of quiet beauty. The artist's dedication to her craft, coupled with her willingness to embrace vulnerability, suggests that VelumVelvet is poised to become a significant voice within the contemporary music scene, one that prioritizes emotional depth and artistic integrity above all else.

The music of VelumVelvet feels like stumbling upon a hidden gem, a dimly lit, exquisitely decorated ballroom where conversations linger long after the dancing has stopped. It's an immersive experience, meticulously crafted by Donna James, a nurse and poet from Brigg, England, who has unexpectedly unleashed a potent force onto the musical landscape. The project began with a simple, ambitious challenge: to create pop songs that weren't just catchy tunes, but miniature cinematic scenes, complete with narrative threads and evocative atmospheres.

James's work is rooted in a profound nostalgia for the 1980s, a period she describes as platform two, a starting point for her artistic explorations. This influence





# A Sweet Disaster That Sounds Wonderful



James Taupo is a name rapidly gaining traction within the UK's pulsating house and speed garage scene. Hailing from Birmingham, England, this rising producer and DJ is forging his own path with an unwavering dedication to creating music designed for immediate impact. The artist's latest release, *Sweet Disaster*, scheduled for July 17th, 2026, represents a significant evolution in his sound, a full embrace of the 140bpm bounce and euphoric energy that defines speed garage. This isn't simply another track; it's a statement of intent, a bold declaration of Taupo's artistic vision.

The core of *Sweet Disaster* lies in its undeniably infectious euphoria. Massive piano stabs punctuate the driving rhythm, delivering moments of intense melodic release. Crucially, the production is meticulously crafted, built around powerful bass and low-end frequencies designed to translate directly from club speakers to a dancefloor. Taupo's approach reflects a deep understanding of how music functions within a live environment; he prioritizes creating tracks that will ignite a crowd rather than

simply providing background sound for passive listening. The artist explicitly states his desire for the music to translate directly to live DJ sets, an ambition realized through rigorous attention to detail in every sonic element.

The process behind *Sweet Disaster* was intensely self-directed. Taupo handled all aspects of production, a deliberate choice aimed at maintaining complete creative control and ensuring that the track's energy perfectly aligns with his vision. Feedback from peers and university lecturers played a vital role during the mixing and mastering phases, demonstrating a commitment to refining the sound through collaborative critique. This careful process resulted in a polished, dynamic track that is undeniably dancefloor-ready. The focus on crafting a powerful low-end speaks volumes about Taupo's understanding of what truly moves a crowd, the visceral impact of expertly layered basslines.

The artist clearly intends to build upon this momentum, with plans to continue releasing music throughout the year. This latest single is

part of a deliberate strategy to elevate his profile within the electronic music landscape. It signals a transition for Taupo, moving beyond simply producing tracks and becoming an artist determined to connect with audiences through raw, uncompromising sound designed for maximum impact in live environments. The track's energy isn't just loud; it's intelligent, driven by intricate rhythmic patterns and expertly deployed melodic elements that draw the listener into its orbit.

Ultimately, James Taupo presents a compelling portrait of an emerging talent dedicated to sonic innovation. *Sweet Disaster* is more than just a song; it's a testament to his belief in creating music with purpose, music designed to move bodies and build connections within the vibrant world of electronic dance music. He's staking a claim on the 140bpm, and the sound of Birmingham seems poised to echo across the global club scene.



# Francis On My Mind And The Ability to Translate Anxiety Into Music

Francis On My Mind is emerging from the digital landscape with a sound that feels both intensely personal and universally relatable. The artist's music captures the messy, exhilarating experience of modern connection, the impulsive texts, the lingering doubts, the tentative steps toward something real. This new wave indie pop isn't manufactured; it's raw, unfiltered, and brimming with an undeniable energy.

The core of Francis On My Mind's appeal lies in her ability to translate the anxieties and desires of a generation directly into music. She draws heavily from the immediacy of group chats and late-night conversations, crafting songs that feel like eavesdropping on a particularly honest, and sometimes chaotic, exchange. The artist isn't constructing narratives; she is documenting them, preserving fleeting moments in shimmering sonic form. This approach results in tracks that are undeniably addictive, driven by infectious melodies and rhythms that burrow deep into the listener's subconscious. There's a palpable sense of urgency throughout her work, reflecting the feeling of trying to articulate complex emotions before they fade away.

Her sound is characterized by a striking balance between vulnerability and attitude. The production quality reflects this duality,

polished enough to be commercially viable yet retaining an intimate, almost lo-fi feel. It's a deliberate choice that amplifies the emotional weight of her lyrics and creates a sense of immediacy. The tracks aren't afraid to embrace sonic imperfections; these flaws contribute to the overall authenticity, mirroring the messy realities she explores. The music possesses a distinct I shouldn't text him but I will honesty, a refusal to shy away from uncomfortable truths or self-depre-

an upcoming EP slated for release this fall. This collection of songs promises to further explore the themes already present in her singles, delving deeper into the complexities of relationships and self-discovery.

The artist is planning a series of live shows to coincide with the EP's launch, beginning with dates in Budapest, Sofia, and Bucharest. These performances are anticipated to be more than just concerts; they're intend-

ed as immersive experiences, opportunities for fans to connect with her music on a deeper level and witness firsthand the energy that fuels her creative process. She isn't simply presenting songs; she is offering a window into a specific moment in time, a snapshot of unfiltered emotion rendered audible.

Ultimately, Francis On My Mind represents a refreshing new voice in indie

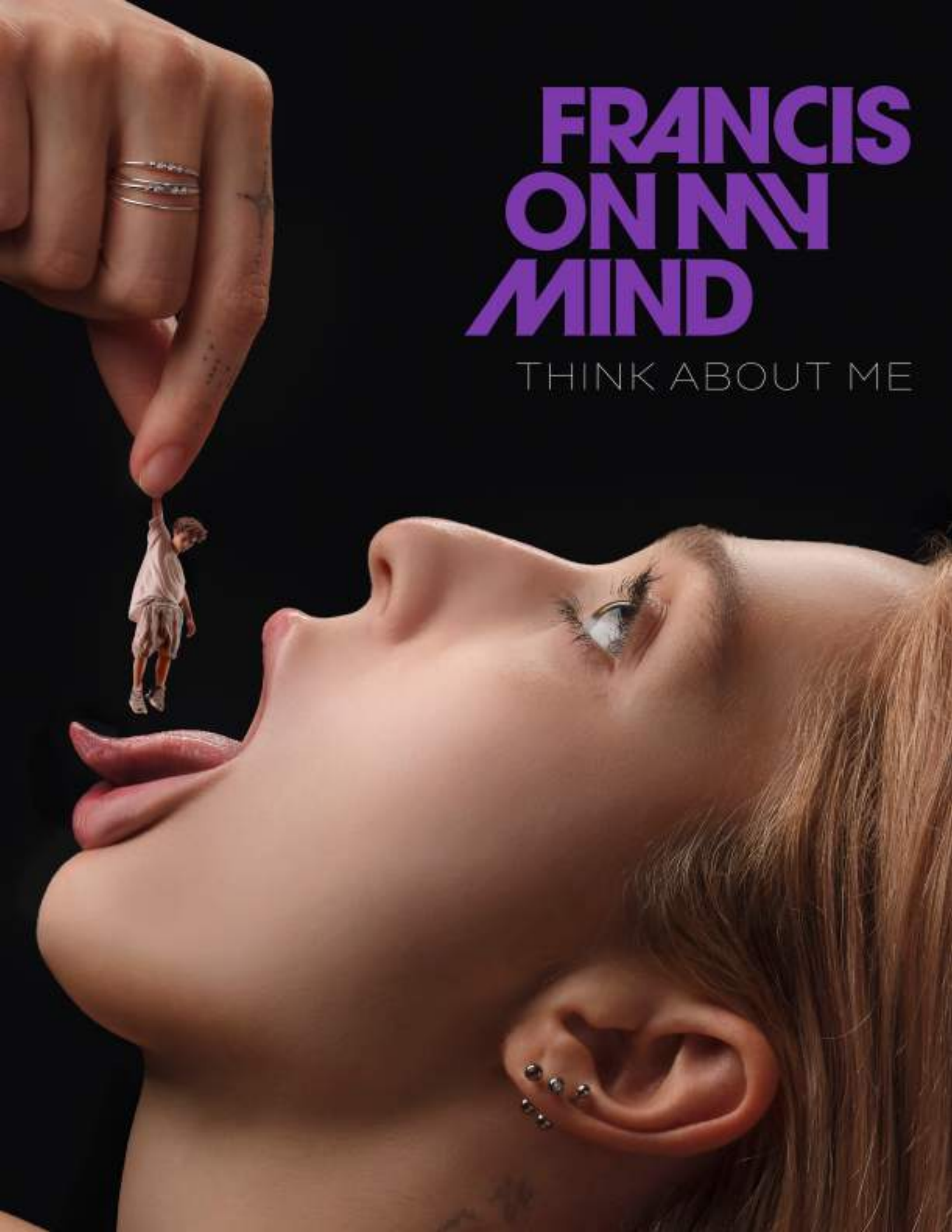
pop, one that prioritizes authenticity and emotional honesty above all else. She's not interested in chasing trends or conforming to expectations; instead, she's carving out her own space within the musical landscape, documenting her experiences with courage and capturing the essence of our shared human condition.

cating observations. This isn't about crafting perfect pop songs; it's about capturing genuine feeling with unflinching clarity.

Recently released, the single showcases this style perfectly. It's a track that immediately grabs attention with its driving beat and brutally honest lyrics, quickly establishing Francis On My Mind as an artist to watch. The song's success hints at a larger project,





A close-up, low-angle shot of a woman's face, tilted back and looking upwards. Her mouth is slightly open, and her tongue is visible. A tiny, miniature figure of a person is hanging from the tip of her index finger. The woman has long, light brown hair and is wearing multiple piercings in her ear. The background is solid black.

# FRANCIS ON MY MIND

THINK ABOUT ME

# 4L Leads the Way in Forging New Sonic Territories

The soundscape is shifting, subtly but undeniably altered by a voice that refuses to be confined. Forty-Four, known professionally as 4L step, is emerging from the vibrant hip-hop scene of Seoul with an approach that feels both intensely personal and globally resonant. He's not simply replicating trends; he's constructing something entirely new, a hybrid terrain where the raw energy of mainland hip-hop collides seamlessly with his uniquely Korean perspective. This artist has quickly garnered attention for his innovative blend, earning him a dedicated following online and signalling a shift in how international artists approach cultural fusion.

At its core, 4L step's music is rooted in rhythmic complexity and lyrical dexterity. He constructs tracks that are simultaneously weighty and airy, often layering intricate drum patterns over melancholic melodies. The production quality is consistently polished without ever sacrificing the raw emotion at the heart of his work. There's a deliberate spaciousness to his sound, the kind that allows each element to breathe and resonate, reflecting an understanding of how sonic architecture can amplify feeling. He frequently

employs samples, but they aren't used as mere decoration; rather, they are carefully woven into the fabric of the songs, adding layers of texture and subtly hinting at influences ranging from classic soul to experimental electronic music.

The artist's artistic process is characterized by a fascinating linguistic dexterity. He seamlessly shifts between Korean and English lyrics, creating a dialogue that feels both natural and deliberate. This isn't simply about switching languages; it's about exploring the nuances of thought and emotion across different linguistic frameworks. The intentional lack of a pronounced distinction between the two languages adds to the overall effect, a sense of fluidity and openness that invites the listener to engage with the music on multiple levels. Lyrics are often introspective, grappling with themes of identity, isolation, and the search for meaning in an increasingly fragmented world. There's a clear emphasis on personal philosophy and subjective experience, communicated through sharp observations and carefully crafted imagery. The artist consciously avoids heavy-handed pronouncements, preferring to suggest rather than

dictate, allowing listeners to draw their own conclusions.

His latest release showcases this approach perfectly. The tracks are meticulously constructed around driving beats and haunting vocal deliveries, exploring themes of urban alienation and the search for connection. It's an album that demands repeated listens, revealing new layers with each immersion. The quality of the recording is exceptional, further emphasizing the artist's commitment to sonic detail and his understanding of how sound can shape emotional responses.

Ultimately, 4L step represents a fascinating evolution within contemporary hip-hop. He embodies a spirit of artistic exploration that transcends geographical boundaries, offering a fresh perspective on universal themes through a distinctly Korean lens. He's not just making music; he's building bridges between cultures and inviting listeners to contemplate the complexities of their own experiences. The artist's unique approach suggests a future where musical boundaries are increasingly porous, and where artists like 4L step will lead the way in forging new sonic territories.





# La Loteria: A Bold Music Choice



Released on July 4th, 2026, La Loteria represents a singular artistic achievement, a reimagining of the traditional Mexican Bingo game transformed into a sprawling hip-hop concept album. The work isn't simply an exploration of music; it's a carefully constructed narrative journey woven through twelve tracks, each directly corresponding to individual playing cards from La Loteria. This intricate design creates a cohesive and immersive experience, presenting something truly novel within the landscape of contemporary music. What immediately distinguishes La Loteria is its bold choice: a fully Spanish-language Boom Bap rap album, an approach previously unexplored in this genre's evolution. The artist firmly believes that they have crafted not just a record, but a timeless piece of art, reflecting their cultural heritage and demonstrating the boundless potential within the world of Spanish-language hip-hop.

The core of Lefty Barnes' sound lies in his lyrical dexterity combined with Element421's meticulous production. The producer's work lays down a solid foundation for the artist's introspective verses, establishing a rhythmic framework that perfectly complements the album's narrative arc.

Each track is built around the unique characteristics and symbolic weight of its associated playing card, resulting in a collection of songs that are both musically compelling and conceptually rich. The beats themselves lean into classic Boom Bap sensibilities, heavy on the drums, soulful samples, and intricate hi-hat patterns, providing a fitting backdrop for Barnes' storytelling abilities.

The collaborative nature of La Loteria is key to its success. Lefty Barnes partnered with Element421, who expertly crafts the sonic landscape, and Big Herk Da Terrible, whose contributions add significant depth to the project's narrative. Big Herk's outro on several tracks serves as a powerful closing statement, grounding the often-abstract lyrical content in a tangible reality. This synergy between producers and artist creates an atmosphere of thoughtful experimentation and genuine artistic intent. The result is a compelling preview of what listeners can expect from the full La Loteria experience.

The single released alongside the album's announcement, a track built around the Number 5 card, showcases this blend perfectly. Element421's production is particularly striking

here, layering atmospheric textures and sharp percussion over a driving bassline, while Barnes delivers a confident and articulate performance. Big Herk's brief but impactful outro elevates the track further, adding another layer of complexity to the already rich soundscape. The collaboration between these three artists, Barnes, Element421, and Big Herk, represents a fresh perspective within the music scene, promising listeners a captivating musical journey.

La Loteria ultimately signifies more than just an album; it's a statement of intent from Lefty Barnes, a dedication to honoring his heritage and pushing the boundaries of hip-hop. The artist's ambition is evident in every carefully crafted lyric and meticulously produced beat, suggesting that this is only the beginning of what promises to be a significant voice within the Spanish-language music community.





# Jasmine: The Sound of Resilience

The sound of Jasmine is a revelation, a carefully constructed landscape of vulnerability and strength. It's an experience that settles deep within the listener, prompting introspection and a profound appreciation for raw emotion. The artist's journey, from the vibrant streets of Brooklyn to the hushed halls of Carnegie Hall, is inextricably woven into every note she crafts. Born in 1994, Jasmine's musical education began not with formal lessons, but with the rich harmonies of church choirs, a foundation that would prove crucial to her distinctive style. These early experiences instilled a deep understanding of vocal dynamics and arrangement, shaping the way she approaches songwriting and performance.

Her transition from choral singing to performing arts school solidified her ambition. Attending this institution provided Jasmine with invaluable training in stagecraft, musical theory, and collaborative artistry. The opportunity to perform at Carnegie Hall, a landmark venue steeped in history, undoubtedly served as a pivotal moment, bolstering her confidence and solidifying her commitment to pursuing music professionally. This early exposure to the grandeur of performance would later inform the artist's approach to creating immersive sonic experiences for her audience.

The genesis of Jasmine's unique sound is rooted in

deeply personal experience, a challenging upbringing that demanded transformation. The decision to change her name represents more than just a stylistic choice; it symbolizes a profound act of self-reclamation and a commitment to translating lived pain into art. This isn't simply about recounting hardships; it's about excavating the core emotions, dissecting them with unflinching honesty, and presenting them through a lens of soulful R&B infused with lyrical dexterity. The artist's music speaks directly to the universal yearning for connection and understanding.

Trib, her latest single, exemplifies this artistic vision perfectly. The production is meticulously layered, combining warm analog textures with subtle electronic elements to create an atmosphere both intimate and expansive. The song's arrangement, a slow build punctuated by moments of soaring vocals and introspective rap verses, mirrors the emotional arc of the narrative. It's designed to evoke a sense of longing, reflection, and ultimately, hope. The track is primed for inclusion in countless playlists; it's destined to become the soundtrack for those quiet moments when vulnerability feels both terrifying and liberating.

Jasmine's approach to her craft transcends genre boundaries. She skillfully blends elements of R&B, hip-hop, and soul, creating a sound that feels si-

multaneously familiar and strikingly original. The emotional tone of her music is consistently earnest and unflinching, inviting listeners to confront uncomfortable truths alongside her. Her lyrical content is characterized by its poetic imagery and honest reflection, exploring themes of identity, loss, love, and resilience with remarkable clarity and sensitivity.

The artist's dedication to meticulous production quality further elevates the listening experience. She prioritizes sonic detail, aiming for a polished yet raw sound that captures the essence of her emotions while maintaining an authentic feel. This attention to detail contributes significantly to the immersive quality of her music, drawing listeners deeper into her world and forging a powerful connection between artist and audience.

Ultimately, Jasmine's music is more than just entertainment; it's a testament to the transformative power of art. It's a chronicle of struggle and survival, filtered through the voice of an extraordinarily talented musician who dares to confront her demons and share her truth with the world. The echoes of resilience within her work resonate far beyond the immediate experience of listening, offering solace and inspiration to anyone grappling with their own journey of self-discovery.







# Land Mass And The Echoes in the Static

The music of Land Mass offers a rare and potent kind of solace. Emerging onto the scene with the July 2026 release of *Fading*, this London-based artist, Greg Zucker, presents an intensely personal alt indie rock experience that immediately grabs hold of the listener's emotions. The EP isn't simply a collection of songs; it's a carefully constructed journey, revealing a talent for blending diverse sonic landscapes into a cohesive and profoundly moving whole. It's an offering built on vulnerability and a dedication to crafting music that speaks directly to the heart's quietest corners.

*Fading* showcases Zucker's remarkable ability to juxtapose contrasting approaches within a single tracklist. *I'll Follow You* establishes an immersive soundscape, drawing listeners into expansive sonic textures reminiscent of Nothing and Slowdive. This immediately creates a sense of vastness and contemplation. Conversely, *Trojan Horses* injects a welcome burst of uptempo energy, leaning into the poppy sensibilities often found in The National's work, demonstrating a sophisticated understanding of songcraft and emotional pacing. This dynamic range isn't jarring; instead, it feels like a natural progression, reflecting a thoughtful consideration

of how to build tension and release within a musical piece. The artist demonstrates an astute awareness of the listener's experience, guiding them through a spectrum of feelings with remarkable precision.

Zucker's influences are clearly present, but he doesn't simply replicate them. He absorbs the atmospheric qualities of bands like Nothing and Slowdive, mirroring their ability to create immersive soundscapes. Furthermore, the melancholic storytelling so characteristic of The National resonates throughout the EP, alongside the haunting introspection found in artists such as Gravenhurst and Sparklehorse. These influences combine to form a distinctive sonic space, one that feels simultaneously familiar and remarkably intimate. The artist's dedication to this particular sound is key to his success.

The creation of *Fading* represents a significant personal milestone for Zucker. He describes the project as something I worked on for me to help me through certain challenges. This honesty informs every note, lending an unparalleled sense of sincerity to the music. The artist candidly reveals that this wasn't intended as a release, but rather a means of processing difficult

experiences and navigating global events he found overwhelming at the time. The fact that every element, writing, recording, and mixing, was completed entirely solo underlines the intensely personal nature of the work. This uncompromising approach results in an undeniably raw and authentic artistic vision.

The production quality of *Fading* is deceptively simple, mirroring the emotional core of the music. There's no polished sheen here; instead, a deliberate rawness elevates the project beyond mere technical proficiency. It's clear that Zucker prioritized honesty and vulnerability above all else, resulting in an experience that feels profoundly genuine. The EP isn't about grand statements or elaborate arrangements; it's about quiet reflection and confronting difficult emotions head-on.

Ultimately, Land Mass offers a glimpse into the creative process of a deeply sensitive artist seeking solace and connection through music. It's a testament to the power of vulnerability and the transformative potential of independent creation, a reminder that even in the echoes of static, beauty can be found.

LAND MASS







Released on 17th April 2026, Pump It All Away is a festival-ready EDM anthem that defies simple categorization, blending celebration and satire in a track designed to make listeners move while leaving space for personal interpretation. Featuring relentless four-on-the-floor beats, massive drops, chant-like vocal hooks, and pumping sidechained synths, the single captures the sensory overload of a packed Pride dance floor while exploring themes of physical perfection, online validation, and instant gratification.

Recorded in Sin Circuit's home studio with creative freedom at its core, Pump It All Away has found unexpected life beyond its original context as part of a Pride club performance. Listeners have embraced the track as a workout anthem and personal empowerment soundtrack, transcending its initial LGBTQ+ cultural setting to reach wider audiences.

The artist's sound is characterized by infectious energy wrapped in playful theatricality, a bold statement from an unafraid to blur boundaries and invite audiences to find their own meaning in the music. The pro-

duction quality is impeccable, with each element meticulously crafted for maximum impact on a dance floor.

Sin Circuit's latest single Pump It All Away stands out not only by its musical prowess but also by its thematic exploration of contemporary queer culture. Through electronic beats and hooks that mimic chants or dance calls, the track encapsulates the frenetic energy often found in Pride events, where attendees join hands to create a collective rhythm.

The emotional tone of Pump It All Away is a harmonious blend of celebration and critique. On one hand, it exudes pure joy with its anthemic chorus designed for mass participation; on the other, it subtly critiques society's expectations and pressures, especially those arising from online validation and the pursuit of perfection.

The artist's influences are manifold, combining elements from contemporary EDM, electronic pop, and even incorporating touches of synth-pop. Influences range from popular mainstream hits to experimental artists who push boundar-

ies within their respective genres. This fusion not only enriches Sin Circuit's sound but also underscores a willingness to challenge conventional expectations in the music industry.

With each release, Sin Circuit continues to evolve both artistically and thematically. From exploring AI transformation to investigating online communities as new forms of identity, Sin Circuit's work delves into diverse themes that resonate with listeners across different contexts and backgrounds. Their ability to blend high-energy beats with thought-provoking lyrics ensures that Pump It All Away is not merely a sound spectacle but an experience that invites deeper engagement and interpretation.

Whether heard as pure celebration or thoughtful commentary, Pump It All Away delivers infectious energy wrapped in playful theatricality, a bold statement from an artist unafraid to blur boundaries and invite audiences to find their own meaning in the music.



# JB Elwood's Ambition

The quiet intensity of JB Elwood's music speaks volumes, a testament to the raw emotion poured into every note. Emerging from the vibrant musical landscape of Austin, Texas, he's quickly establishing himself as an artist deeply connected to both his Appalachian heritage and the universal experience of human connection. His sound isn't simply genre-defined; it's a carefully constructed blend of influences that creates something entirely new and profoundly affecting.

At the heart of Elwood's artistry lies a visceral exploration of vulnerability, particularly evident in tracks like *Who We Are*. The song meticulously recreates the disorienting aftermath of a breakup, a landscape of painful reminders scattered throughout a familiar space. The narrative unfolds with stark honesty, beginning with accusations directed at a former partner, then shifting to a poignant self-reflection before ultimately arriving at a shared understanding of responsibility. It's a journey through the complicated terrain of regret and acceptance, delivered with an unflinching sincerity that resonates deeply. The production quality is deliberately understated, allowing the emotional weight of the lyrics and Elwood's guitar work to take center stage.

Elwood's musical journey began in West Virginia, nurtured by a family steeped in music tradition. The influence of legendary guitarist Slash from Guns N' Roses, a formative experience at age ten sparked by *Welcome to the Jungle*, laid the foundation for his passion and technique. His upbringing within a musical family instilled in him a deep appreciation for diverse sounds, ranging from traditional fiddle and banjo tunes to gospel music broadcast on local radio. This rich tapestry of influences informs his songwriting and playing style, creating a sound that is both rooted in tradition and forward-thinking in its approach.

He describes himself as a city boy with a country heart, a phrase that perfectly encapsulates the duality of his artistic identity. The legacy of his grandfather, John Elwood Ball, a small business owner who instilled a strong work ethic, is woven into the fabric of his music alongside the memories of family gatherings and stories passed down through generations. The acquisition of his grandfather's 1960s Gibson Dove guitar further solidifies this connection to his past, providing both an instrument and a

tangible link to his lineage. The name JB Elwood itself is a tribute to this influential figure, symbolizing the journey he has undertaken to establish himself as a musician.

Elwood's relocation to Austin solidified his commitment to pursuing his musical ambitions. He intentionally sought out a city known for its thriving music scene and welcoming community, recognizing it as the ideal launchpad for his career. He intends to capitalize on this momentum with a series of releases throughout the year and into next year, including live-in-studio video performances and extensive touring across Texas.

Ultimately, JB Elwood's ambition is simple: to craft music that speaks to the shared human experience. He aims to create songs that explore themes of love, loss, resilience, and adventure, stories that transcend geographical boundaries and resonate with listeners regardless of where they call home. His vision, to be the soundtrack to your life, suggests a deep desire to connect with audiences on an emotional level, offering solace, inspiration, and a shared sense of understanding through the power of music.





# Braaheim Created A Sound That is Instantly Recognizable

The artist, Braaheim, has carved a remarkable space for himself within the pulsating heart of global dance music. He's not simply replicating nostalgia; he's excavating it, transforming familiar melodies into something entirely new and undeniably vibrant. His journey began in Norway, steeped in the energy of legendary après-ski venues like LAAVEN, an experience that would profoundly shape his musical sensibilities. For over thirteen years, Braaheim has been a consistent force within the Norwegian club scene, steadily building a dedicated following fueled by a distinctive approach to reimagining beloved tracks.

His sound is immediately recognizable, a potent fusion of electronic music's driving pulse with deeply rooted tribal rhythms and the undeniable groove of classic basslines. Yeke Yeke, his most recent release, exemplifies this perfectly. It's a fresh interpretation of the iconic Chic track, meticulously layering modern electronic elements atop the original's core structure. The result is an infectious explosion of energy, undoubtedly designed to ignite dance floors worldwide. He consistently delivers music that feels both familiar and strikingly contemporary, successfully bridging the gap between generations. The artist clearly prioritizes staying true to the spirit of the

original songs while simultaneously injecting them with a distinctly modern electronic sensibility, a combination that resonates powerfully within today's musical landscape.

The success of Yeke Yeke, and indeed much of his work, reflects a meticulous approach to production quality. His tracks are polished without sacrificing their raw energy, demonstrating an understanding of how to balance intricate sound design with the core emotional impact of the source material. This has translated into staggering numbers: over 550 million streams across his discography and a consistent monthly audience exceeding three million listeners on Spotify. The artist's dominance isn't limited to Scandinavia either; his remixes of tracks like Rhythm Is A Dancer and Paradise have consistently topped Scandinavian charts and secured prominent positions on major global playlists.

Braaheim's influence extends beyond just remakes. His collaborations have been a key component of his rise to prominence. Partnerships with artists such as K-391, MOTi, Fast Boy, and the acclaimed Norwegian musician Shaman Durek (Shaman Prince) have further broadened his reach and showcased his versatility. These collaborations earned him several golden re-

cords globally, solidifying his position within the electronic music community. The artist's ambition clearly extends beyond simply recreating existing hits; he's actively seeking opportunities to connect with a diverse range of talent and explore new sonic territories.

Looking ahead, 2026 promises even more exciting developments as Braaheim embarks on a series of rapid-fire collaborations. Details remain scarce, but the artist hinted at a string of speedy collaborations, suggesting an ongoing commitment to innovation and experimentation. The continued success of his musical journey is a testament to his dedication to honoring the past while boldly shaping the future of dance music. Your favourite ginger boy, as he's affectionately known, continues to remind us that some classics are best experienced through a fresh and undeniably energetic lens.





# Raw Energy and Character



Coup d'éclat, released on 29th May 2026, is a masterpiece in technical hard rock that showcases everything Ermyte stands for. Recorded using traditional methods with real amplifiers in a cabin to capture authentic warmth and character, this single delivers an explosive sonic experience from start to finish.

The artist's sound is immediately arresting, a potent blend of virtuosity and visceral emotion. Coup d'éclat exemplifies this perfectly, delivering a wall of sound built on foundational hard rock elements yet propelled by a distinctly modern sensibility. The core of the track is undeniably powerful; soaring vocals that hit high notes with precision are layered over a funky bassline which breaks free from conventional structures. This isn't just simple rhythm; it's an actively engaging element, driving the song forward with infectious energy. Adding to this dynamic is a series of intricate tapping guitar riffs, showcasing technical skill and melodic creativity. But the true centerpiece is undoubtedly the blistering shred solo, a demanding piece that com-

pels repeated listens, demonstrating an undeniable command over the instrument. It's a moment of pure instrumental fireworks, crafted for maximum impact.

The production quality is key to the success of Coup d'éclat. The decision to record in a cabin using real amplifiers clearly paid off, resulting in a rich, warm sound that avoids the sterile feel often associated with modern rock production. This approach allows the raw energy and character of the music to shine through, contributing significantly to the track's overall impact. The recording process seems central to the artist's vision, a deliberate rejection of overly polished or digitally-processed sounds in favor of an authentic, organic experience.

French musicians have always been known for their passion and artistry, and Ermyte are clearly carrying on this tradition. The band's ambitions extend beyond simply replicating established hard rock tropes; they are aiming to awaken the genre with a powerful sound and meaningful lyrics. The emphasis on French language

adds another layer of depth and resonance to the music, grounding it in a specific cultural context while simultaneously appealing to a broader audience. It's this combination of linguistic richness and musical intensity that distinguishes Ermyte from many of their contemporaries.

The artist has stated a desire to tour extensively, fueled by a shared dream of bringing their music to life on stage. This ambition suggests a commitment to delivering live performances that are as captivating and energetic as the recordings. The band's goal is not merely to release music, but to build a community around their sound, one rooted in both technical mastery and genuine emotional expression.

Ermyte represents a compelling new force within hard rock. They skillfully combine technical proficiency with heartfelt emotion, offering a fresh perspective on a genre often dominated by formulaic approaches. Coup d'éclat is a potent demonstration of their potential, a statement of intent that firmly establishes Ermyte as an artist to watch.



# OBLIK OBLOKI: A clear dedication

The music scene is rarely defined by predictable trajectories, yet OBLIK OBLOKI seems to be charting a course entirely its own. Emerging from the Netherlands in 2026, this experimental music project has rapidly gained attention for its distinctive blend of sound and its unwavering commitment to sonic exploration. Following the promising debut single, Eyes & Ears, the duo is now poised to solidify their place within the contemporary independent music landscape with their latest offering, Forever Young.

Forever Young immediately announces a shift, not in direction, but in intensity. The track skillfully marries shimmering indie pop melodies with an unexpectedly bouncy synth bassline. Driving percussion provides a solid foundation, while bright guitars add layers of texture and vibrancy. However, it's the vocal arrangement that truly elevates the song. Melodic vocal croons initially weave through playful verses, gradually building toward soaring, infectious hooks, creating a truly captivating effect. The piece culminates in an upbeat, vibrant, triumphant finale that leaves the listener energized and eager for more.

The core of OBLIK OBLOKI's success lies in the creative partnership between Sonam Plomp and Lennard Vaarten. Formed from a shared vision, the project represents a meticulously crafted synergy of musical ideas. Both Plomp and Vaarten contribute significantly to every aspect, instrumentation, production, and vocals (provided by Vaarten). This collaborative process results

in immersive soundscapes that are both complex and deeply engaging. The duo's approach centers on challenging conventional structures within music, aiming instead to deliver unique auditory experiences. Forever Young builds directly upon the foundations established by Eyes & Ears, demonstrating a clear dedication to continued growth and refinement of their artistic vision.

The production quality of OBLIK OBLOKI's work is consistently impressive. The artist clearly prioritizes detail, layering sounds with precision and employing techniques that enhance both the warmth and the dynamism of each track. This attention to sonic texture allows for a feeling of spaciousness within the music, contributing significantly to the immersive nature of their soundscapes.

The project's influence can be traced back to a desire to create something wholly new. It's evident in the careful construction of each song, a deliberate movement from quieter moments of introspection to bursts of energetic release. This dynamic range is central to the artist's overall aesthetic and draws listeners into an engaging journey.

OBLIK OBLOKI represents more than just another musical act; it's an embodiment of creative exploration and collaborative spirit. The project's continued evolution, as demonstrated by Forever Young, suggests a future brimming with innovative sounds and captivating experiences, a testament to the power of two artists determined to redefine what contemporary music can be.





# The Energy of Rellyo Bambini

Rellyo Bambini has always occupied a space just outside the mainstream, and his latest project, *Lucky Starz and The MoonDawgz*, solidifies that position with exhilarating force. This isn't simply an album; it's a meticulously constructed world, a vibrant, slightly unsettling landscape populated by strange characters and fueled by cosmic energy. It's an invitation to step into something wholly unique, a sonic exploration spearheaded by an artist unafraid to embrace the delightfully bizarre.

The project unfolds like a soundtrack to a lost sci-fi street movie, immediately establishing a playful yet serious tone. The listener is drawn into a universe of underground swagger and surreal imagination, one where neon lights cast long shadows over forgotten corners. This isn't music designed for passive listening; it demands attention, rewarding curiosity with layers of intricate detail. At its

core, *Lucky Starz and The MoonDawgz* showcases the artist's remarkable ability to seamlessly blend disparate genres. He expertly weaves together elements of hip-hop, alternative pop, futuristic funk, electronic textures, and theatrical storytelling.

The production quality contributes significantly to this immersive experience. It's polished without sacrificing its raw energy, creating a sound that is both undeniably catchy and profoundly unusual. The music possesses a cinematic scope, evoking images of bustling cityscapes and desolate, technologically advanced environments. There's an underlying current of humor woven throughout the tracks, balanced with a confident, almost defiant attitude, a characteristic that adds to the project's distinct personality. The artist utilizes electronic textures to create rich soundscapes, often juxtaposing them with the rhythmic pulse of hip-hop beats.

This newest release continues Rellyo Bambini's trajectory as an independent force, building upon a growing catalog of experimental releases. Previous work had already begun to explore themes of identity, artificial futures, strange fame, and outsider creativity, concepts that are now amplified within this ambitious project. *Lucky Starz and The MoonDawgz* represents a significant step forward, deepening the artist's commitment to a colorful, dystopian, and cinematic style. It's a deliberate choice for listeners seeking an alternative to conventional musical offerings, those who appreciate artistry that dares to push boundaries.

Ultimately, Rellyo Bambini isn't just making music; he's constructing narratives. *Lucky Starz and The MoonDawgz* is a testament to his vision, a bold declaration of artistic independence, inviting the audience into a world where imagination reigns supreme and the rules are delightfully rewritten.





# Owen Cogen's Sonic Bloom

Owen Cogen is a sonic architect, meticulously constructing worlds within his music that resonate with a potent sense of quiet unease. Emerging from the stark beauty of Central Oregon's high desert and finding a home in the bustling musical landscape of Boston, he has quickly established himself as an artist unafraid to confront difficult emotions, loneliness, neglect, and anxiety, with unflinching honesty. His approach is deeply personal; he writes, records, mixes, and masters every element of his releases, ensuring complete control over the final product and a raw authenticity that permeates each track. This dedication translates into music characterized by both intricate detail and an expansive sound palette.

Cogen's musical style is difficult to neatly categorize, existing comfortably within the alternative and indie rock genres while simultaneously incorporating elements of electronic and orchestral music. His guitar work is particularly noteworthy, often described as subtly off-kilter, it creates a feeling of controlled dissonance that perfectly complements the themes explored in his lyrics. The artist utilizes a deliberate blend of analog and digital production techniques, layering warm, textured sounds with sharp, precise electronic beats. This combination gives his music a unique character, one that feels both timeless and contemporary. He draws inspiration from a range of sources, including classic rock bands known for their introspective songwriting and the textural experimentation found in more avant-garde electronic artists. The result is a soundscape that's simultaneously familiar and unsettlingly new.

The artist's commitment to crafting dynamic music is evident in his approach to production. A recent single exemplifies this perfectly. It begins with a subdued atmosphere, built upon aggressive bass lines and ethereal synth pads, creating an immediate sense of isolation. As

the track progresses, these elements gradually intensify, building towards a cathartic release. The core of the song's power lies in its careful construction; it slowly accumulates tension before culminating in a powerful wall of distortion that exposes the raw emotional weight beneath the restrained atmosphere. This isn't simply an explosion of noise; it's a carefully controlled moment of vulnerability. The track then deliberately returns to the initial quietude, reinforcing the cyclical nature of the themes, suggesting that despite any outward expression of emotion, the fundamental feeling of isolation persists.

Cogen's background in performance is integral to his musical identity. He incorporates a wide range of instruments and textures into his compositions, constantly seeking new ways to create interesting moving music. This willingness to experiment contributes significantly to the rich sonic tapestry of his work. The artist isn't interested in simply creating songs; he's building soundscapes, bold, immersive experiences that demand attention. His lyrical detail is equally impressive, offering poignant observations about the human condition with a deftness and precision that elevates his songwriting beyond simple emotional expression.

Ultimately, Owen Cogen represents a compelling voice within the indie music scene. He's an artist deeply invested in exploring complex emotions through meticulous sound design and honest lyricism. His work speaks to a pervasive sense of disconnection in the modern world, offering a space for listeners to confront their own feelings of loneliness and anxiety with both vulnerability and strength.









# The Rover: A Distinctive Indie Sensibility



The feeling of leaving is a potent one, a blend of sorrow and exhilaration that can be difficult to articulate. Anette Fjellhede has managed to capture this complex emotion with remarkable precision in *The Rover*, a track that resonates with a quiet strength and an undeniable sense of forward momentum. The song isn't just about escaping; it's about actively forging a new path, one built on self-reliance and the courage to face the unknown.

Born in Stockholm, Fjellhede's musical journey began long before *The Rover* materialized. From her formative years, deeply influenced by the raw energy of Led Zeppelin, she developed an inherent understanding of what constitutes truly compelling music, something that carries weight and possesses a palpable presence. This foundation informs her approach today, where she listens with a discerning ear, favoring tracks that evoke genuine feeling above all else. Her musical tastes are broad, reflecting a desire to continually expand her sonic palette while remaining steadfast in her commitment to authentic expression.

For many years, Fjellhede's primary creative outlet was as the lead singer and songwriter for the local rock band Yesterday's Gone. This experience proved invaluable, honing her skills in both lyrical composition and

musical arrangement. The band's success included numerous performances on various stages, solidifying their place within Stockholm's vibrant music scene. However, recent years have witnessed a shift in Fjellhede's focus, an increasing dedication to the solitary pursuit of crafting her own material.

This evolution is marked by a distinctive indie sensibility, a move away from purely traditional rock structures towards more

with the songs on a deeply personal level.

*The Rover* exemplifies this approach perfectly. The track's atmospheric soundscape is driven by a steady, rhythmic pulse that feels like a purposeful stride forward. It's a sonic roadmap designed for liberation, from the constraints of a past that no longer serves to the empowering realization of being just a rover, someone free to explore and define their own destiny. The song intends

to resonate with those who value independence and the skill of moving onward without dwelling on what has been left behind.

The accessibility of her work is key to Fjellhede's vision. Both *The Rover* and Yesterday's Gone's extensive catalogue are readily available online, inviting listeners to delve into her musical world. The link provided allows anyone to experience the artist's current

creative direction firsthand.

Ultimately, Anette Fjellhede's music represents a commitment to honest expression and a profound understanding of the transformative power of movement, both literal and metaphorical. She offers an anthem for those seeking to shed old burdens and embrace the boundless possibilities that lie ahead.





# Neon Dreams And Emotional EDM

Mr Dendo is a sonic architect emerging from the heart of Rome, Italy, constructing immersive experiences within the world of Genderless Dance Music. This burgeoning producer has quickly established himself as a force to be reckoned with, captivating audiences with his meticulously crafted soundscapes, a potent fusion of 90s nostalgia and the pulse of modern EDM. The artist's work isn't simply music; it's an invitation to step back in time while simultaneously propelling forward into the future of dance.

The foundation of Mr Dendo's distinctive style lies in his ability to seamlessly blend familiar elements with a distinctly contemporary approach. He draws heavily from the influential sounds of icons like Alan Walker, known for his atmospheric and melodic electronic productions, and Gigi D'Agostino, whose signature melancholic synth-pop created an enduring legacy. However, Mr Dendo transcends mere imitation; he elevates these influences through a profoundly personal lens. This is most evident in his collaborative work with the legendary Gigi D'Agostino, a partnership that has undeniably shaped the trajectory of his artistic identity. The result is a sound both instantly recognizable and refreshingly original.

His latest single, *Astronaut*, released on

October 9th, 2024, provides a powerful illustration of this approach. The track immediately transports listeners to a place where shimmering synths intertwine with driving basslines, creating an atmosphere that feels simultaneously nostalgic and futuristic. The production quality is remarkably polished, showcasing a keen attention to detail - particularly in the layering of textures and the dynamic range. The song's minimalist vocal hook, repeated throughout, serves as a key element, contributing significantly to its appeal on social media platforms while retaining a core emotional resonance.

The emotional DNA underpinning Mr Dendo's music is undeniably rooted in melancholy. He skillfully weaves together moments of profound sadness with bursts of euphoric energy, creating a captivating tension that keeps the listener engaged from beginning to end. This sensitivity is further reinforced by his clear influence from classic Italian dance music, a genre renowned for its heartfelt melodies and introspective themes. Fans recognizing this heritage will immediately appreciate the depth and complexity within each track. Listeners drawn to the work of Eiffel 65 and Molella would also quickly understand the core tenets of Mr Dendo's creative vision.

The artist's musical journey began at the tender age of eight, suggesting a lifetime dedicated to honing his craft and cultivating a deep understanding of sound design. This early exposure has clearly shaped his approach, imbuing his productions with an authenticity that feels both genuine and deeply considered. *Astronaut* specifically demonstrates this commitment, a meticulously constructed piece that showcases not just technical proficiency but also a profound artistic vision. The track's success speaks to the artist's ability to tap into universal emotions through carefully crafted melodies and rhythms, creating a listening experience that is both intellectually stimulating and emotionally rewarding.

Ultimately, Mr Dendo represents more than just another dance music producer; he embodies a dedication to sonic exploration and emotional honesty. His unique blend of influences, combined with his evident passion and meticulous production, position him as an exciting new voice within the genre, one poised to resonate deeply with audiences who appreciate both nostalgic echoes and forward-thinking innovation.





## ILYAN: Creating Soundscapes With Detail

The energy is palpable. A current of rhythmic anticipation sweeps through crowded dance floors, fueled by a relentless beat and an undeniable sense of euphoria. This feeling, this pulse, is undeniably the work of ILYAN. Emerging from Austria, he's rapidly establishing himself as a force within the global electronic music scene, crafting tracks that are both intensely energetic and deeply rooted in soulful emotion. His sound isn't simply about creating dance music; it's about building an experience, a collective moment where inhibitions dissolve and movement takes over.

ILYAN's musical DNA is a fascinating blend of influences, House music's foundational groove meets the infectious rhythms of Afrobeat and the vibrant spirit of Afro House. He expertly weaves these elements together, resulting in tracks that are undeniably modern yet possess an ancient, primal quality. The core of his production lies in driving percussion, carefully layered synths, and a powerful sense of forward momentum. It's this combination that makes his music so immediately captivating and perfectly suited for the environments he consistently targets: festivals, beach clubs, and those coveted late-night dancefloors

where energy is at its peak. The artist clearly understands the power of a well-crafted groove, meticulously constructing each track to maximize its impact.

His recent single, GOGO, provides a stunning example of this approach. The track immediately grabs the listener with an infectious, driving beat and a distinctly feel-good summer vibe. It's a sonic embodiment of the global Afro House movement, transporting listeners to sun-drenched shores filled with vibrant energy. The production is clean and polished, showcasing Ilyan's attention to detail while retaining a raw, organic quality. Importantly, he incorporates distinctive rap vocals that add another layer of complexity and urban sensibility to the sound. These vocal elements aren't just thrown in; they're integrated seamlessly into the overall composition, enhancing the rhythmic flow and adding an intelligent lyrical dimension.

The artist consistently emphasizes the dual nature of his music, its ability to thrive both within a club setting and as a personal listening experience. He consciously creates music that works equally well on the dancefloor and through headphones, demon-

strating a sophisticated understanding of sonic dynamics. This focus on emotional flow is central to Ilyan's artistic vision; he strives to create tracks that resonate with listeners on a deeper level, evoking feelings of joy, release, and connection. It's this careful balance between high-energy movement and sincere emotion that truly sets his work apart.

ILYAN's ambition extends beyond simply creating commercially viable dance music. He is clearly focused on building a cohesive brand around a specific aesthetic, one defined by rhythmic energy, warm Afro-inspired grooves, and urban lyricism. The artist's dedication to crafting music with strong playlist and club potential speaks volumes about his commercial awareness, but more importantly, it reflects his understanding of what truly connects with audiences: authentic sound and undeniable momentum.

Ultimately, ILYAN represents a new wave in electronic music, one that embraces global influences, prioritizes danceable vibes, and isn't afraid to fuse genres seamlessly. He's an artist on the rise, driven by a clear vision and an innate ability to create music that moves people.







# MILK & HONEY

## ALLAN JAMISEN

Phoenix-based composer and painter Allan Jamisen continues his exploration of memory, identity, and emotional displacement with *Milk & Honey*, a stirring new single that expertly blends atmospheric sophistication with deeply personal songwriting. The artist's work consistently seeks to capture the complicated nuances of returning to familiar spaces, those places imbued with the ghosts of past experiences, only to find they no longer resonate in the same way. This latest offering showcases a masterful ability to evoke a specific, unsettling feeling: that of disorientation and quiet sorrow.

The soundscape of *Milk & Honey* is remarkably layered, drawing on a diverse range of influences spanning several decades and genres. Shimmering dream-pop textures provide an ethereal foundation, while warm sophisti-pop elegance adds a touch of classic melodic sensibility. The artist's lyricism is deeply reflective, focusing on the intangible aspects of place and belonging. There's a palpable sense of searching, a yearning for something lost or perhaps never possessed. The track doesn't shout; it whispers, allowing the listener to become fully immersed in its melancholic beauty. It mirrors the sophisticated approach found in artists like Burt Bacharach and Leonard Cohen, yet retains an undeniable energy reminiscent of The Rolling Stones and Iggy Pop.

Jamisen's musical journey is a testament to persistent explo-

ration and a willingness to embrace diverse influences. His early experiences as a member of the district honor choir in Phoenix, coupled with his time singing and songwriting with Danny Saber in Los Angeles, established a foundation built on classic rock sensibilities. The influence of figures like Frank Sinatra and James Brown, artists known for their emotional depth and rhythmic complexity, clearly informs his approach to composition. Further enriching this tapestry are the echoes of The Velvet Underground's experimentalism and David Bowie's theatricality, alongside the more subtle nuances of Lee Hazelwood's unique style.

The artist's commitment to crafting his own sound is evident in his early use of a Tascam Porta One 4-Track cassette recorder, a testament to self-reliance and a dedication to capturing raw emotion. This dedication led to important connections, beginning with introductions from Gaynel Hodge, the songwriter behind Earth Angel, and ultimately reaching out to producers like Kim Fowley, who facilitated submissions to labels such as SST Records.

His relocation to Copenhagen in 1991 marked another significant chapter, leading to collaborations with Claes Cornelius, a record company executive involved with international hits like Ace of Base's *The Sign*. Recordings took place at Cornelius' studio within the Galleri Projekt art gallery, blending

artistic expression across both music and visual mediums. These sessions extended into producing electronic music with Frederik Birket-Smith, who held positions as a DJ, promoter, and club owner, roles that solidified Jamisen's presence within Copenhagen's vibrant arts community.

Around 2005-2006, a renewed collaboration emerged with John X Volaitis, a veteran recording engineer/producer who had previously worked with artists like Whitesnake and The Rolling Stones. This partnership brought a fresh perspective to the project, showcasing the artist's ability to synthesize diverse influences into a cohesive and emotionally resonant whole.

*Milk & Honey* serves as a compelling reminder of Allan Jamisen's artistic dedication, a pursuit driven by an insistent desire to translate complex emotions and experiences into sonic landscapes that are both deeply personal and universally relatable.











# The Weight of Water

A cinematic journey unfolds through the evocative soundscapes crafted by Melinda Joy and Son of Cormack, a partnership that's capturing hearts and minds with its raw emotion and stunning visuals. Emerging from the wild beauty of South West Ireland, this duo is forging a unique path in contemporary music, blending poetic storytelling with richly layered instrumentation. The recent release of *Out of the Blue*, an award-winning song and accompanying music video, provides a potent glimpse into their artistic vision, a vision that's both deeply personal and universally resonant.

The core of *Out of the Blue* lies in Melinda Joy's songwriting, stemming from a poem inspired by the dramatic landscapes she calls home. Her lyrical style is characterized by intricate wordplay and an ability to distill complex emotions into simple, yet profound phrases. The song itself beautifully captures the ambiguity inherent in new love, interwoven with themes of landscape's influence on imagination and a yearning for liberation. Son of Cormack's contribution adds a soulful depth, his vocals complementing Joy's perfectly, creating a dynamic that feels both familiar and utterly fresh. The production quality is exceptional; it avoids overt embellishment, allowing the inherent beauty of the music and its setting to shine through. The

produced entirely by Joy and Cormack alongside Juro Kosec, elevates the experience even further. Shot across breathtaking locations within West Cork, Kerry, Wicklow, and Dublin, it's an indie-style short film that feels both intimate and expansive. The cinematography by Kosec is particularly noteworthy, utilizing natural light and carefully framed compositions to heighten the emotional impact of the song. The video's success has been widely recognized; numerous awards and recognitions from film festivals attest to its artistic merit, specifically for Best Music Video, Best Original Song, and Best Music. The artists recently concluded a significant summer tour across the UK and Europe, solidifying their presence on the international stage. Highlights included two key slots at StourJam, the largest charity music festival in the UK, alongside performances in Dublin, Brussels, and London. A visit to the Berlin Music Video Awards further underscored the video's impact.

Melinda Joy's musical background is equally compelling. She's a singer-songwriter and bass player with a diverse range of influences that inform her distinctive sound. Her previous album, *Beautiful Illusions* (2020), showcased this versatility, while *Unbound* (2004), released as part of her earlier band M.J. Baby & The Last

Ph.D. in psychology / creativity studies, which informs the content of her popular podcast, *Syncreate: Empowering Creativity*. This podcast explores the fascinating connections between creativity, psychology, and spirituality, offering insights that resonate with a wide audience. She's also a published author, having received a Silver Nautilus Award for her book on creativity.

George McCormack, known as Son of Cormack, brings his own unique perspective to the partnership. Born and raised with Irish and Scottish heritage, he draws inspiration from his diverse background, from listening to jukebox lullabies in English pubs to living and working in London and ultimately settling in Austin, Texas. His music, frequently featured by BBC *INTRODUCING*, reflects these influences, adding another dimension to the duo's captivating sound. Currently, both Melinda Joy and Son of Cormack are diligently working on full-length solo albums slated for release within the next year, promising an even broader exploration of their individual talents and artistic visions. The combination of Joy's poetic lyricism and McCormack's soulful vocals and instrumentation paints a picture of a duo poised to become a significant force in contemporary music, offering a deeply moving and visually arresting experience.

Photo by Patrick Larson

Photography



**Join our membership  
for a monthly full page  
feature!**



- A full page in our magazine a QR code leading back to your release/social media.
- Your music/project on our website (Spotlight & Artists section)
- We add the full page at the end of every post on our social media (carousel)
- One additional photo on every carousel post on Instagram (we post 4-7 days per week)
- Your music on Indiefferential radio streaming music 24/7 online
- We suggest your music/project to our readers via our mailing list (1-2 mails per month)

FEATURING INDIE  
MUSIC SINCE 2021

# INDIEFFERENTIAL



## MAGAZINE

INTERVIEWS ARTICLES FEATURES CONCERTS

[WWW.INDIEFFERENTIAL.COM](http://WWW.INDIEFFERENTIAL.COM)



### Waterproof Titanium Automatic Diver Watch

Introducing our latest collection, the ADMIRAL GMT Titanium Automatic Dive Watch, also marking BODERRY's debut GMT time-piece. Crafted with a 40mm brushed titanium case, this watch features a bezel and dial coated with Japan's ultra-bright luminescent paint, enhancing visibility in low-light conditions.

Use CODE: INDIEFFERENTIAL  
for 10\$ Off

